



FAITH FOUNDATIONS STUDY SERIES

Foundations of Faith: A Study Workbook

The Core Truths Every Young Christian Should Own - A First Serious Study for Ages 13-19



Ages 13-19 - Homeschool & Youth Groups

Personal Study - Small Groups - Reproducible for one household or class

HOW TO USE THIS STUDY

Getting the Most From This Workbook

Maybe you grew up in church, or maybe this is all new. Either way, this study lays the foundation: who God is, who you are, what went wrong, how Jesus rescues, and how to live it out. It's called 'Foundations' because everything else you believe is built on these six units. For ages 13 to 19.

1 CORINTHIANS 3:11

"No one can lay any foundation other than the one already laid, which is Jesus Christ."

A Few Suggestions

- ☐ Find a consistent time and place. Even 15 focused minutes beats an hour you never start.
- ☐ Keep a pen in hand. Writing your answers turns reading into real thinking.
- ☐ Read each passage in your own Bible too, and note the version differences.
- ☐ Be honest in the reflection and journal sections - no one is grading you.
- ☐ If you meet with a group, come having already written your answers.
- ☐ Pray before you begin. Ask God to teach you, not just inform you.

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UNIT 1

Who Is God?

"In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth." - Genesis 1:1

Unit Overview

Everything starts with God. This unit explores his character - holy, loving, powerful, personal - as the foundation for everything else you believe.

DEVOTIONAL

Starting With God

If you get God wrong, everything else bends around the mistake. So we start here.

GENESIS 1:1

"In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth."

The Bible does not argue for God's existence; it assumes it and shows his character in action.

God is both transcendent (far above us) and personal (near to us). Holding both keeps faith honest and warm.

Reflect

1. What picture of God did you grow up with? Is it accurate?

2. Which of God's qualities do you most need to know is true right now?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me know you as you really are, not as I've assumed.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

God Reveals Himself

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

EXODUS 34:6-7

"And he passed in front of Moses, proclaiming, 'The Lord, the Lord, the compassionate and gracious God, slow to anger, abounding in love and faithfulness, maintaining love to thousands, and forgiving wickedness, rebellion and sin. Yet he does not leave the guilty unpunished.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. List every quality God names about himself here.

2. What is God 'slow to' and 'abounding in'?

3. What does God not do?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

God Reveals Himself

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. How do God's mercy and justice fit together?

2. Why does it matter that God describes himself rather than us guessing?

Application - What will I do?

1. Which quality of God challenges you most?

2. How does knowing God's character change how you approach him?

WORD STUDY

Holy

MEANING

Set apart, pure, wholly other. God's holiness means he is perfect and distinct from all creation.

Where It Appears**ISAIAH 6:3**

"Holy, holy, holy is the Lord Almighty; the whole earth is full of his glory."

1 PETER 1:16

"Be holy, because I am holy."

Dig Deeper

1. Why is God's holiness both awe-inspiring and comforting?

2. What would it mean for your life to be 'set apart'?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Picture of God

Describe how you honestly picture God.

Where might that picture be off?

What quality of God do you want to know better?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Does God Even Exist?

THE QUESTION

Is there good reason to believe God is real?

Think It Through**Something from nothing**

The universe had a beginning; a beginning points to a cause beyond itself.

Design and order

The fine-tuned conditions for life invite the question of a designer.

Moral sense

Our deep sense that some things are truly wrong points beyond mere opinion.

Your Response

1. Which reason resonates with you most?

2. What honest question about God's existence do you still carry?

UNIT 2

Who Am I?

"So God created mankind in his own image." - Genesis 1:27

Unit Overview

Identity is the biggest battle of the teen years. This unit anchors your worth not in performance or approval but in being made and loved by God.

DEVOTIONAL

Made in His Image

You are surrounded by voices telling you your worth is your looks, grades, or followers. God says something different.

GENESIS 1:27

"So God created mankind in his own image, in the image of God he created them."

Your value is not earned or ranked; it is assigned by your Maker. You bear God's image before you achieve anything.

That means your worth cannot be increased by success or destroyed by failure. It is a gift, not a score.

Reflect

1. Where do you tend to look for your worth?

2. How would believing you're made in God's image change a hard day?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me find my identity in you, not in performance or approval.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Known and Formed

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

PSALM 139:13-16

"For you created my inmost being; you knit me together in my mother's womb. I praise you because I am fearfully and wonderfully made; your works are wonderful, I know that full well. My frame was not hidden from you when I was made in the secret place... your eyes saw my unformed body. All the days ordained for me were written in your book before one of them came to be."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What did God do before you were born?

2. How does the writer describe himself?

3. What did God know about your days?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Known and Formed

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. What does 'fearfully and wonderfully made' mean for how you see yourself?

2. How does being 'known' comfort and challenge you?

Application - What will I do?

1. What do you criticize about yourself that God calls 'wonderfully made'?

2. How can you speak to yourself differently this week?

WORD STUDY

Image of God (Imago Dei)

MEANING

The truth that every human uniquely reflects God, giving all people inherent dignity and worth.

Where It Appears**PSALM 8:5**

"You made them a little lower than the angels and crowned them with glory."

JAMES 3:9

"With the tongue we... curse human beings, who have been made in God's likeness."

Dig Deeper

1. If everyone bears God's image, how should you treat people you dislike?

2. How does this truth confront racism, bullying, and cruelty?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Who I Really Am

List the labels others (or you) put on you.

What does God say is true about you?

Which of God's truths do you most need to believe?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Identity is a shared struggle. Be honest about the pressures.

1. Where do people our age get their sense of worth?

2. How does social media shape identity - for better or worse?

3. How can this group speak truth over each other's labels?

UNIT 3

What Went Wrong?

"For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God." - Romans 3:23

Unit Overview

If God and people are good, why is the world such a mess? This unit honestly faces sin - what it is, why it matters, and why we can't fix it ourselves.

DEVOTIONAL

Naming the Problem

You don't have to be told the world is broken; you feel it. The Bible names the reason without flinching.

ROMANS 3:23

"For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God."

Sin is not just breaking rules; it is a broken relationship - living as though we, not God, are the center.

Admitting the problem is not depressing; it's the first honest step toward a real solution.

Reflect

1. Where do you see brokenness in the world and in yourself?

2. Why is it hard to admit we can't fix ourselves?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, give me honesty about my sin and hope in your solution.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Heart of the Problem

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

ROMANS 7:15, 18-19

"I do not understand what I do. For what I want to do I do not do, but what I hate I do... For I have the desire to do what is good, but I cannot carry it out. For I do not do the good I want to do, but the evil I do not want to do - this I keep on doing."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What tension does Paul describe in himself?

2. Does he lack the desire to do good?

3. What does he keep doing anyway?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Heart of the Problem

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why is willpower alone not enough to fix sin?

2. How does Paul's honesty encourage you?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where do you experience Paul's struggle?

2. What does this reveal about your need for help beyond yourself?

WORD STUDY

Sin

MEANING

Falling short of God's standard; rebellion against God and the brokenness that flows from it.

Where It Appears**ISAIAH 64:6**

"All of us have become like one who is unclean."

1 JOHN 1:8

"If we claim to be without sin, we deceive ourselves."

Dig Deeper

1. Why do people resist the word 'sin' today?

2. How is honesty about sin actually freeing rather than shaming?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Facing the Truth

What sin patterns do you keep returning to?

Where have you tried to fix yourself and failed?

What would it mean to bring this honestly to God?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Aren't People Basically Good?

THE QUESTION

If humans are made in God's image, why say we're sinful?

Think It Through**Both are true**

People carry real dignity and real brokenness at the same time.

The evidence

History and honest self-reflection both reveal that good intentions aren't enough.

Not despair

Naming sin isn't hating humanity; it's diagnosing a problem so it can be healed.

Your Response

1. How do you hold together human dignity and human sinfulness?

2. Where have you seen good intentions fail to produce good?

UNIT 4

The Rescue

"For God so loved the world that he gave his one and only Son." - John 3:16

Unit Overview

This unit is the heart of the gospel: what Jesus did on the cross and at the resurrection, and how it answers the problem of sin.

DEVOTIONAL

The Great Exchange

The whole Bible builds to a rescue. This is the center of the Christian faith.

2 CORINTHIANS 5:21

"God made him who had no sin to be sin for us, so that in him we might become the righteousness of God."

On the cross, Jesus took what we deserved and gave us what we could never earn. That's the exchange at the heart of the gospel.

Grace is not God ignoring sin; it's God absorbing its cost himself.

Reflect

1. What does it mean to you that Jesus took your place?

2. Have you personally received this rescue, or just heard about it?

PRAYER PROMPT

Jesus, thank you for taking my place. Help me truly receive your grace.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

It Is Finished

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

JOHN 19:28-30

"Later, knowing that everything had now been finished, and so that Scripture would be fulfilled, Jesus said, 'I am thirsty.' A jar of wine vinegar was there, so they soaked a sponge in it, put the sponge on a stalk of the hyssop plant, and lifted it to Jesus' lips. When he had received the drink, Jesus said, 'It is finished.' With that, he bowed his head and gave up his spirit."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What does Jesus know at this moment?

2. What are his final words?

3. What is 'finished'?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

It Is Finished

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does 'It is finished' matter for how we relate to God?

2. What can you not add to a finished work?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where are you still trying to 'finish' what Jesus already finished?

2. How does this bring rest?

WORD STUDY

Salvation

MEANING

God's rescue of people from sin and death, freely given through faith in Jesus Christ.

Where It Appears**EPHESIANS 2:8-9**

"For it is by grace you have been saved, through faith."

ROMANS 10:9

"If you declare with your mouth 'Jesus is Lord' and believe... you will be saved."

Dig Deeper

1. Why is it important that salvation is received, not earned?

2. What does declaring 'Jesus is Lord' actually commit you to?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Response

Where are you in your response to Jesus' rescue?

What holds you back from fully trusting him?

Write a prayer responding to the cross.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

The cross is the center. Talk about what it means personally.

1. Why do you think grace is so hard to accept?

2. How would you explain the gospel to a friend in one minute?

3. How can this group pray for each other's next step?

UNIT 5

New Life

"Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, the new creation has come." - 2 Corinthians 5:17

Unit Overview

Salvation isn't just forgiveness of the past; it's a new identity and a new power to live. This unit explores what changes when you follow Jesus.

DEVOTIONAL

Made New

Following Jesus is not turning over a new leaf by willpower; it's receiving new life.

2 CORINTHIANS 5:17

"Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, the new creation has come: The old has gone, the new is here!"

You are not just forgiven and left the same; you are given the Holy Spirit and a new identity.

Growth is now cooperation with a power inside you, not a solo effort to be good enough.

Reflect

1. What 'old' things do you most want to leave behind?

2. How does having God's Spirit change the way you fight sin?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, thank you for new life. Help me live from who I now am in you.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Life in the Spirit

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

GALATIANS 5:16-18

"So I say, walk by the Spirit, and you will not gratify the desires of the flesh. For the flesh desires what is contrary to the Spirit, and the Spirit what is contrary to the flesh. They are in conflict with each other, so that you are not to do whatever you want. But if you are led by the Spirit, you are not under the law."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What are we told to walk by?

2. What two things are in conflict?

3. What happens when we're led by the Spirit?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Life in the Spirit

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. What does it mean to 'walk by the Spirit' daily?

2. Why is this a walk, not a single leap?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where is the 'flesh vs. Spirit' battle strongest in you?

2. What is one Spirit-led step this week?

WORD STUDY

Regeneration

MEANING

The new spiritual birth God gives believers - being 'born again' with new life and desires.

Where It Appears**JOHN 3:3**

"No one can see the kingdom of God unless they are born again."

TITUS 3:5

"He saved us through the washing of rebirth and renewal by the Holy Spirit."

Dig Deeper

1. What is the difference between self-improvement and being 'born again'?

2. What new desires have you noticed since drawing near to God?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

The New Me

What has begun to change as you've grown in faith?

What old pattern do you want God to keep transforming?

What does 'new life' look like for you practically?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Live the New Life

New life is lived out in daily choices. Practice it.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Start each day acknowledging your identity in Christ.
- ☐ When tempted, pause and ask the Spirit for help.
- ☐ Replace one old habit with a life-giving one this week.
- ☐ Thank God each night for one way he helped you.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 6

Living It Out

"Let your light shine before others." - Matthew 5:16

Unit Overview

Faith is meant to be lived in community and shared with the world. This unit looks at the church, mission, and a life that points to Jesus.

DEVOTIONAL

Not Meant to Be Alone

Christianity was never designed as a solo sport. You grow in community and shine outward.

MATTHEW 5:16

"Let your light shine before others, that they may see your good deeds and glorify your Father in heaven."

Your faith is personal but not private. It's meant to be visible and shared - not to show off, but to point to God.

You also need others: a community to grow with, be honest with, and be strengthened by.

Reflect

1. Do you have a community that helps your faith grow? If not, how could you find one?

2. How is your faith visible - or hidden - right now?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, plant me in real community and let my life point to you.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Early Church

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

ACTS 2:42-47

"They devoted themselves to the apostles' teaching and to fellowship, to the breaking of bread and to prayer... All the believers were together and had everything in common. They sold property and possessions to give to anyone who had need. Every day they continued to meet together... And the Lord added to their number daily those who were being saved."

Observation - What does it say?

1. List what the believers devoted themselves to.

2. How did they treat their possessions?

3. What happened as a result?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Early Church

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why is community central to this picture of faith?

2. What made this community attractive to outsiders?

Application - What will I do?

1. Which of these practices is missing from your life?

2. How could you help build community like this?

WORD STUDY

Church

MEANING

Not a building but the community of Jesus' followers - his family, called to worship, grow, and serve together.

Where It Appears**MATTHEW 18:20**

"For where two or three gather in my name, there am I with them."

HEBREWS 10:24

"Let us consider how we may spur one another on toward love and good deeds."

Dig Deeper

1. What has your experience of church been - good, bad, mixed?

2. What could you contribute to a community of believers?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Next Steps

What is the most important thing you've learned in this study?

What is one way you'll live your faith more openly?

Write a prayer for the road ahead.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Commissioned

The final discussion. Look outward and forward.

1. How can your faith be more visible without being fake?

2. What's your plan for staying in Christian community?

3. How can this group keep encouraging each other after this study?

MEMORY & MEDITATION

Hide This Word in Your Heart

GENESIS 1:1

"Genesis 1:1"

Context

Look back over the verses you studied in this book.

Why It Matters

Scripture memorized becomes a resource the Holy Spirit can bring to mind in real moments of decision, temptation, doubt, and encouragement.

Write It From Memory

LIVE IT OUT THIS WEEK

Choose one verse from this book to carry with you all week.

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Memory Verse Review

Write out from memory: Genesis 1:1

Write out from memory: Genesis 1:27

Write out from memory: Romans 3:23

Write out from memory: John 3:16

Write out from memory: 2 Corinthians 5:17

SELF-ASSESSMENT

Spiritual Check-In

Rate each statement honestly. This is between you and God - there are no wrong answers, only honest starting points.

1 = rarely 5 = consistently

I make time to read the Bible on my own.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I pray about real things in my life, not just at meals.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I can explain what I believe and why.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I treat people the way Jesus would.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I invite God into my decisions before I make them.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I am honest even when it costs me.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I serve others without expecting anything back.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I go to God first when I am anxious or afraid.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Final Reflection

Which foundation truth do you most need to stand on?

How has your understanding of God, yourself, and the gospel grown?

Write a prayer committing your foundation to Christ.

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Study Notes

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